GES-NEWS

GEOSCIENCE, ENVIRONMENTAL SCIENCE, AND SUSTAINABILITY NEWS

Issue 3 · November 2026 Hofstra University · Geology, Environment and Sustainability

News, Events, and Opportunities for Students

NEAREST DEADLINE

Rutgers Climate Symposium, abstracts due: 9 November

FROM THE EDITOR

This is the third issue of GES-NEWS, for students in the Department of Geology, Environment and Sustainability (GES) and in related subject areas. The newsletter brings together deadlines, internships, scholarships, field trips, volunteer opportunities and news about courses and about the work faculty and students in this department are doing.

This issue also lists funded PhD and Master's places, in the United States and abroad, in the section Funded Graduate Study.

To keep receiving GES-NEWS, subscribe here. To send in an article or an item, see the last section.

CLOSING SOON

Present Your Research at Rutgers

CONFERENCE

Rutgers Climate Symposium 2026, Douglass Student Center, New Brunswick, New Jersey

Wednesday 18 November. Abstracts close 9 November, registration closes 12 November

A day of plenary talks and panel discussions on climate research, followed by a poster session where students present their own work. Talks run from 9:00 AM to 12:30 PM and the poster session from 1:30 to 3:00 PM. Attendance is free for students, faculty and staff from academic institutions.

To present a poster, submit an abstract by 9 November. Everyone who attends, presenters included, registers by 12 November.

Details and registration

Present Your Research on Campus EVENT

Fall 2026 Undergraduate Research and Creativity Day

Thursday 10 December. Your faculty mentor registers you by 16 November

A poster session for undergraduates from all departments, 11:30 AM to 1:00 PM in the Student Center Multipurpose Rooms, with creative performances and projects from 2:00 to 4:00 PM in the Guthart Cultural Center Theater. The session suits a poster already shown at a conference, an honors thesis, or another advanced research project. Posters are 36 by 48 inches; the Hofstra print shop prints a poster, unmounted, for $45.

Ask the professor you work with: professors register students, not students themselves.

A Paid Leadership Programme on Long Island

INTERNSHIP

YES Long Island (Youth, Empowerment, Sustainability), sponsored by the National Grid Foundation with United Way of Long Island

The aim is to choose students by the end of November

A pilot programme on food access (whether people can get enough food) and food sustainability, with workshops and visits to food pantries, farms and school gardens. Participants also read project proposals from community groups and recommend which ones receive money from a small grant fund. Students receive a stipend (a fixed payment) and earn volunteer hours. The charity United Way is looking for three Hofstra students, from any field of study, especially those interested in sustainability, agriculture, environmental studies, public policy or community development. The first meeting is planned for the first week of December, and the activities continue through the spring semester.

Dr. Bennington says the programme could count as the internship course SBLY 180. To have your name sent to the organisers, email him: j.b.bennington@hofstra.edu

A Geology Scholarship for Juniors and Seniors

SCHOLARSHIP

Angelo Tagliacozzo Memorial Geological Scholarship, Northeast Section of the American Institute of Professional Geologists

Closes Friday 4 December 2026

You must be a junior or senior (a third-year or fourth-year undergraduate) majoring in a geological science at a college in the northeastern United States (New York is included), with at least 30 credit hours of geology courses by the end of your senior year. Awards are based mainly on financial need and academic record, and the committee may limit awards to two students from one college. The application includes a transcript, a financial need form and a letter written by you. A professor sends the recommendation letter directly to the committee, so ask your professor early. Awards are decided in March 2027. Geology majors qualify. If you study environmental resources or sustainability, ask the scholarship committee (the scholarship page gives the contact details of the committee) whether your major counts.

Details and application: ne-aipg.org/Scholarship_Information

Present Your Research in Saratoga Springs

CONFERENCE

Geological Society of America (GSA), Northeastern Section Meeting, Saratoga Springs, New York

11 to 14 March 2027. Abstracts close 8 December 2026

The regional meeting of the Geological Society of America for the northeastern United States, with talks and posters from Friday 12 to Sunday 14 March, all in person, and sessions planned for students. To present, submit an abstract (a short summary of the research) by 8 December; the abstract fee is $20 for student members of GSA and $38 for students who are not members. Write the abstract with the professor who guides your research.

Details: gsameetings.secure-platform.com/ne27

ON AND NEAR CAMPUS EVENTS

Summer Research: How to Apply EVENT

Research Experiences for Undergraduates (REU) information session, Hofstra Mathematics Department and Math Club

Monday 9 November, 4:30 PM, Roosevelt Hall 111. No registration needed

Research Experiences for Undergraduates (REUs) are summer research programmes for undergraduates, funded by the National Science Foundation (NSF), a United States government science agency. REUs exist in any subject the NSF funds, the Earth and environmental sciences included, and students receive a stipend

(a fixed payment for the summer). A position paid for by the NSF is open only to United States citizens, permanent residents and United States nationals, so a student on a student visa should read the rules of the programme.

At the session Dr. Adam Sheffer, who leads the NYC Discrete Mathematics REU and the Polymath Jr. REU, and two former REU students explain what the programmes are, where the programmes run and how to apply. The speakers are mainly mathematicians, but the session is planned for students of all science departments. You do not need research experience. For most REUs, the deadline to apply is between January and March, and most REU programmes have not yet started taking applications for summer 2027.

Search the list of REUs

Lithium, Batteries and Clean Water EVENT

Online talk, International Association of GeoChemistry

Thursday 5 November, 2:00 PM New York time, on Microsoft Teams

Lithium is used in the batteries of electric cars and in storing solar and wind power, but extracting lithium can affect water supplies. Dr. Gordon Williams, a geochemist at Brown University, speaks about research on lithium deposits, from dry salt lakes in Bolivia to hard-rock mines in North Carolina, and on the water quality around the deposits. The talk is free and open to anyone; a recording is posted afterwards.

Join the talk on Teams

Mapping the Politics Behind Climate Policy EVENT

Lecture by the Department of Global Studies and Geography with the Hofstra Cultural Center

Wednesday 11 November, 2:40–4:05 PM, Breslin 103

Dr. Erin Friedman, a geographer at Hunter College of the City University of New York, asks why scientific knowledge about climate has not led to larger cuts in greenhouse gas emissions. She compares three ways of studying climate policy texts: careful reading by people, computer analysis of the words, and methods that use artificial intelligence (AI) to combine both. Entry is free and open to the public, and advance registration is required.

Details and registration

Free Dinner With Professional Geologists EVENT

Long Island Association of Professional Geologists

Next dinner meeting in early December. The date is not set yet

The association holds a dinner meeting four times a year, with talks and panel discussions on geoscience research topics and on working in environmental and geotechnical consulting. The association sponsors up to five students at a meeting, so those students eat for free, and the department can usually arrange a van from campus. Dr. Bennington coordinates attendance and transportation.

ONE OF OURS

Department Research on Composting Is Published

Published in the journal Sustainability, free to read online, October 2026

Allison Alberti, a graduate of the department, and Renee Lista, a graduate student in the department, are co-authors with Dr. Sasha Pesci, a professor in the department, of a research article on New York City's curbside composting programme (food waste is turned into soil), which collects food waste left outside homes. The study asked residents of Queens, the most diverse of the city's five boroughs (districts), whether residents knew about and used the programme: 83 residents answered a survey and eight were interviewed. About half of those surveyed used the programme, and the main reason the others did not was that the others had not heard of the programme.

To ask about joining a research project with a professor, write to any GES professor.

Read the article

ACADEMIC CALENDAR AND OTHER DATES TO KNOW

- **8 November (Sunday):** last day for undergraduate students to withdraw from a single course (not from all courses).
- **25 to 29 November:** Thanksgiving break, classes not in session.

Checked against Hofstra's own calendar, 27 September 2026 (hofstra.edu/academics/calendar/fall-2026).

Spring 2027 Courses in GES

A selection from Dr. Bennington's Spring 2027 course guide, emailed to all GES students on 8 October; the guide also says which degree requirement a course meets. The GEOL 121 lecture and GEOL 142 times below differ from the guide; the times below are the official ones now. WI marks a Writing Intensive course (one with a large amount of writing); STEAM stands for science, technology, engineering, arts and mathematics.

Course	Instructor	Days and times
GEOL 002 Historical Geology (WI)	Bennington	Tue, Thu 2:40–4:35 PM
GEOL 015 Global Climate Change	Bernhardt	Mon, Wed 2:40–4:35 PM
GEOL 020 Introduction to Field Methods	Farmer	Tue, Thu 12:00–2:25 PM
GEOL 121 Hydrology	Bennington	Wed, Fri 9:10–10:05 AM; laboratory Fri 10:30 AM–1:25 PM
GEOL 142 Geostatistics	Marsellos	Mon, Wed 10:10 AM–12:35 PM
HUHC 020E Community Engaged Sustainability	Marsellos	Fri 9:30 AM–12:30 PM
SBLY 002 Sustainability Planning and Policy	Bernhardt	Tue, Thu 9:40–11:05 AM
SBLY 025 Communicating the Climate Change Crisis	Young	Mon, Wed 2:40–4:05 PM
SBLY 120 Sustainability and Food	Pesci	Tue, Thu 9:40–11:05 AM
WST 150A STEAM Careers for Everyone (WI)	Farmer	Mon, Fri 11:20 AM–12:45 PM

HUHC 020E is a seminar of the Hofstra University Honors College; students outside the Honors College may join by invitation: ask Dr. Marsellos (antonios.marsellos@hofstra.edu). Graduate students cannot count undergraduate courses towards their degree. For advice on which courses to take: Dr. Bennington (j.b.bennington@hofstra.edu) for undergraduates, Dr. Jase Bernhardt (jase.e.bernhardt@hofstra.edu) for graduate students. SBLY 025 also carries the code PR 129, for public relations students. Graduate students who want to take SBLY 025 should ask Dr. Bernhardt how to register.

LOOKING TO NEXT SUMMER

These summer positions are decided in the winter; you can start preparing an application now.

Paid Research on the Hudson River FELLOWSHIP

Undergraduate Research Fellowship, Hudson River Foundation, with the New York State Department of Environmental Conservation, summer 2027

Applications open in December

A paid summer research project of your own on the Hudson River and its watershed (the land that drains into it), on the river's plants and animals and water, or on the people who live along the river and use the river. The fellowship is for third-year and fourth-year undergraduates, and you need a professor to guide the project; GES professors can guide the project. A student chosen receives an $8,000 stipend (a fixed payment for the summer) and training in writing a research article. Four to six students are chosen per year.

If you have an idea for a project, talk to a GES professor now: the proposal is written with the professor. To be told when applications open: bit.ly/hrf-urf

Paid Summer at a National Laboratory — INTERNSHIP

Science Undergraduate Laboratory Internships (SULI), United States Department of Energy, summer 2027

Closes 6 January 2027, 5:00 PM Eastern Time

You must be a United States citizen or permanent resident, at least 18 years old when the internship begins, and a full-time student or a recent graduate. A paid ten-week summer research internship at a Department of Energy national laboratory, such as Brookhaven National Laboratory on Long Island.

Apply: science.osti.gov/wdts/suli

A Paid Summer on a Sustainability Team — INTERNSHIP

Green Teams, PSEG Institute for Sustainability Studies, Montclair State University, summer 2027

Closes 29 January 2027

Eleven weeks of full-time, paid work in a team of five students, on a sustainability project set by a host organisation. The programme is for undergraduates from any major and any university: students who are now in their first year or later are welcome, but seniors graduating before August 2027 are not eligible. The programme runs from 24 May to 5 August 2027 with a planned $7,500 stipend, and on-campus housing is available on request.

Details: inside.montclair.edu/pseg_iss. Apply: application form

Two Years of Paid Study — SCHOLARSHIP

Hollings Undergraduate Scholarship

Closes 31 January 2027, 11:59 PM Eastern Time

Two years of support for your studies, up to $9,500 per year, and a paid summer research internship at a facility of the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA).

You must be one of these: a full-time second-year student in a four-year programme, a full-time third-year student in a five-year programme, or a community college (a two-year college) or transfer student who is applying to a four-year institution. You must be a citizen of the United States and hold a cumulative grade point average of at least 3.0.

Apply: noaa.gov/office-education/hollings-scholarship

Paid Research on the Upper Atmosphere — INTERNSHIP

Research Experiences for Undergraduates, MIT Haystack Observatory, Massachusetts, summer 2027

Closes 1 February 2027

You must be a United States citizen or permanent resident who does not graduate before the programme starts in June. Summer research in space and atmospheric science at an observatory of the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT), with a stipend of $620 a week.

Details: haystack.mit.edu

Summer Job: National Park — INTERNSHIP

Scientists in Parks, summer 2027

Applications open in mid-December

A paid placement in a national park doing real resource work: mapping, monitoring, geographic information systems, and explaining the park's science to visitors, in parks across the United States. A position closes after 60 applicants have applied.

Details: scientistsinparks.org/how-to-apply

Paid Research One Hour Away — INTERNSHIP

Lamont-Doherty Summer Intern Program

2027 dates not posted yet. Watch from early January

Ten weeks of paid summer research in Earth, ocean, atmospheric and environmental science at Lamont-Doherty Earth Observatory in Palisades, New York, about an hour from campus. The 2026 round paid a $7,000 stipend with free accommodation in a hall of residence.

Details: lamont.columbia.edu

FUNDED GRADUATE STUDY

Paid Master's and PhD Places — FELLOWSHIP

A funded place pays the tuition and a stipend (a fixed payment) or a salary for teaching or research during the degree.

- **30 November 2026:** ETH Zurich (the Swiss Federal Institute of Technology), Excellence Scholarship for a master's degree starting in autumn 2027, Earth sciences included. Open to international students with a bachelor's result in the top 10%; CHF 13,500 per semester and the tuition. ethz.ch
- **2 December 2026:** University of Edinburgh, two funded PhDs that use satellite radar measurements of ground movement, one on climate and mountain building in the Tian Shan mountains of Central Asia and one on forecasting failure in mines. Open to United Kingdom and international applicants. e5-dtp.ed.ac.uk
- **14 and 16 December 2026:** University of Portsmouth and University of Plymouth (United Kingdom), two funded PhDs with the company Cornish Lithium, on faults, geothermal energy and lithium. The announcement does not state who may apply. trees-dla.ac.uk
- **15 December (the yearly date):** Stony Brook University, School of Marine and Atmospheric Sciences, master's and PhD. Applications received by 15 December receive full consideration for paid teaching and research assistantships; international applicants are accepted. stonybrook.edu
- **1 January 2027:** Georgia Institute of Technology, PhD on critical minerals (rare earth elements in sediments of the Atlantic coast), with 36 months of support. Apply by sending a statement of interest and a curriculum vitae (CV) to Dr. Karl Lang, karl.lang@eas.gatech.edu.
- **6 January 2027:** Central England doctoral training partnership in Earth and environmental sciences (CENTA), United Kingdom, PhD studentships. International students may apply, but the studentship pays the tuition only at the rate for United Kingdom students. centa.ac.uk
- **11 January 2027:** Imperial College London, Janet Watson PhD Scholarship in Earth Science and Engineering. Open to United Kingdom and overseas applicants; a stipend for three and a half years and the tuition. Write to a possible supervisor first. imperial.ac.uk
- **15 January (the yearly date):** Rutgers University, Earth and Planetary Sciences PhD. The priority date for admission with five years of support (teaching assistantships or fellowships); international applicants are accepted. eps.rutgers.edu

Also open, deadline not specified. Professors announced these funded places in October 2026; write to the professor or the page named to ask about the deadline.

- Utah State University, fully funded master's and PhD places in earthquake science, starting in spring, summer or autumn 2027. qanr.usu.edu/wees
- Tulane University (New Orleans), funded PhD on how rivers cut new channels across river bends, starting in spring or autumn 2027. Dr. Kyle Straub, kmstraub@tulane.edu
- University of Auckland (New Zealand), funded three-year PhD on coastal cliff failure, with a stipend and the fees, starting early to mid 2027. Dr. Mark Dickson, m.dickson@auckland.ac.nz
- Durham University (United Kingdom), funded PhD on computer models of dryland ecosystems, with a stipend and the fees. iapetus.ac.uk
- University of Derby (United Kingdom), fully funded PhD on storing heat underground. derby.ac.uk
- Geological Society of America, Jack Kleinman award for volcano research in the United States, up to $5,000, for undergraduate and graduate students; applications are taken from October to December 2026. geosociety.org

WRITE FOR GES-NEWS

GES-NEWS is looking for student contributing editors, whose names are printed at the top of the issues the editors work on.

What contributors write:

- A first-person account of an internship, a field season, or a summer project
- Your own research finding, written so that a first-year student understands the finding
- A report from an event, a field trip or a conference, with photographs
- Anything about student life in GES that other students would want to know

None of these needs scientific writing.

Writing for people outside your subject is a separate skill, and a useful one to have.

To contribute a piece, or to join as a contributing editor for the year, write to the editor, antonios.marsellos@hofstra.edu, with GES-NEWS in the subject line.

How the dates are checked. Every application deadline here was checked on the website or in the official announcement of the organisation, last on 2 November 2026. If an organisation has not posted next year's deadline yet, as with the Lamont-Doherty summer internship, this newsletter says "not posted yet" and never prints last year's date.

GES-NEWS is published for GES students at Hofstra University, nine issues a year, September to May. Errors reported to the editor are corrected in the next issue.

Founding Editor and Publisher: Dr. Antonios E. Marsellos

Co-Editor: Dr. J Bret Bennington

Contributors to this issue: Dr. E. Christa Farmer, Allison Siegel and Peter B. Young